

Cognitive Behavioral Therapy Interventions



Precontemplation: Not intending to change in the next 6 months. The focus specific to cognitive behavioral therapy should be on becoming better informed about factors that affect a healthy lifestyle through use of behavior therapy techniques.	
Name of Intervention	Description of Intervention
Recognizing a Problem Exists (Problem Solving)	Ask the client if a friend, family member, or medical professional has ever identified a problem with the client's health (e.g., high blood pressure, high cholesterol, overweight, depression, arthritis, diabetes).
My Everyday Life (Journaling)	Ask the client to start journaling his or her day, including moments of stress and moments of happiness.
Contemplation: Intending to change within the next 6 months. The focus specific to cognitive behavioral change should be on using CBT interventions that provide opportunities for clients to identify benefits of healthy change specific to them.	
Name of Intervention	Description of Intervention
Life in Review (Journaling)	Have the client learn how to plan for and overcome exercise barriers by listing three personal barriers (e.g., not enough time, too tired) and two possible solutions to each barrier.
Accurately Defining the Problem (Problem Solving)	Have the client identify other forms of activity that he or she could do that are easily achieved and not directly related to exercise (e.g., taking the stairs, parking farther away).
Identify Negative Thoughts (Rational Emotive Therapy [RET])	Have the client learn how to cope with eating temptations by listing three personally tempting situations (e.g., going to happy hour with coworkers, cookies in the break room at work) and two possible alternatives that will result in a healthier outcome while still satisfying the client.
Determine Schemas (Schemas)	Identify two activities that are mildly or moderately enjoyable to the client that would suggest ideas of what the client could enjoy (e.g., golfing, fly-fishing, going to the zoo).

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Preparation: Intending to change in the next month. Cognitive behavioral therapy interventions should focus on helping the client prepare for a healthy lifestyle.	
Name of Intervention	Description of Intervention
What Do I like to Eat? (Self-Monitoring)	Before the client decides to make any changes in his or her meal planning, have the client create a simple food journal for a week (it does not have to track anything more than the serving size and maybe calories) so the client can become accustomed to self-monitoring practices with food.
How Active Am I? (Self-Monitoring)	Before the client decides to engage in physical activity, have the client use a self-monitoring device such as a pedometer or create an activity journal so the client can become accustomed to self-monitoring practices with physical activity.
Decision Making (Problem Solving)	Have the client follow steps from the intervention titled “Accurately Defining the Problem” in the Contemplation section. Then, have the client decide which of the potential solutions is the best solution to help solve (or in some cases address) the health problem.
Determine How to Combat Negative Thoughts (RET)	In conjunction with the client, develop a list of automatic problematic thoughts and turn-around thoughts (refer to the “Introduction to RET Principles” section).
Action: Just beginning to change. The focus should be on using cognitive behavioral therapy techniques that help facilitate healthy behavior change.	
Name of Intervention	Description of Intervention
Verification (Problem Solving)	Have the client follow the steps from the intervention titled “Decision Making” in Preparation section. Then, have the client implement the solution in practice and determine if it is working for his or her needs.
How Am I Eating? (Self-Monitoring)	Have the client keep a food journal (on paper or with a phone app) that records what he or she is eating, at what time, how many calories, macronutrient levels, mood, and daily totals.
How Am I Moving?	Now that the client is active, have the client keep track of his or her physical activity through the use of an activity journal or a smartphone app.
EAT (RET)	Have the client maintain an EAT journal (refer to the “Introduction to RET Principles” section).

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Maintenance: In the process of change for 6 months. Cognitive behavioral therapy interventions should focus on helping the client maintain change.	
Name of Intervention	Description of Intervention
Develop Coping Statements (Stress Management)	Have the client develop coping statements he or she can use when the client faces a challenge during the exercise and/or nutrition program.
Develop Resilience (Stress Management)	Have the client make a strong commitment to an action that can be repeated 21 days in a row (e.g., take the stairs every day for 21 days, eat breakfast every day for 21 days).